



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*alamarthena kāmēna sukṛtenāpi karmaṇā |
ebhyaḥ saṃsāra-kāntāre na viśrāntamabhūnmanaḥ || 10 | 7 |*

— Aṣṭāvakra-gītā, Prakaraṇa 10 (Chapter 10), Verse 7

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Enough of wealth, enough of desire, enough even of virtuous deeds! In this vast wilderness of worldly existence, your mind has found no rest through any of them. This verse from the Aṣṭāvakra-gītā pierces through the illusions we chase, the mirages we mistake for true refreshment. It speaks to the inherent restlessness within us, the constant striving that promises fulfillment but delivers only fleeting satisfaction.

Think about your own life. How much time and energy do you invest in accumulating wealth, pursuing desires, or even engaging in seemingly virtuous activities? We tell ourselves that once we achieve a certain financial status, find the perfect partner, or perform enough good deeds, we will finally be happy. Yet, the Aṣṭāvakra-gītā gently reminds us that these are all external pursuits, and true peace lies not in the external world, but within ourselves.

The "wilderness of worldly existence" isn't a place "out there," but a state of mind. It's the constant craving, the relentless pursuit of something more, the inability to be content with what is. The verse isn't advocating for abandoning all responsibilities or indulging in recklessness. Instead, it's a call to examine the motivations behind your actions. Are you acting from a place of genuine love and compassion, or are you seeking validation and a sense of worth?

The wisdom of this verse is profoundly relevant in today's hyper-connected and materialistic world. We are bombarded with messages that constantly tell us we need more – more possessions, more experiences, more recognition. This creates a perpetual state of dissatisfaction, preventing us from truly appreciating the present moment. The Aṣṭāvakra-gītā offers a radical alternative: to turn inward, to discover the stillness within, and to find contentment not in what we acquire, but in who we are. It challenges us to question the very foundations of our beliefs about happiness and fulfillment, and to embark on a journey of self-discovery that leads to lasting peace.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you truly at rest within yourself, or are you still seeking validation from external sources?